



THE PATNA INITIATIVE

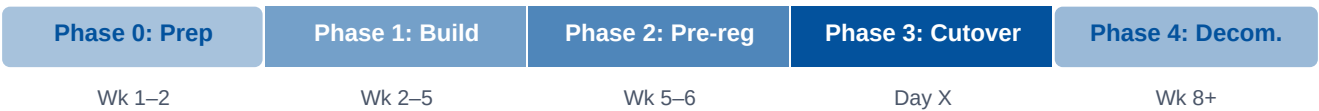
DEVELOPER BRIEF · 2025

Website Migration Strategy

Technical brief for the development team · thepatna.org

This document outlines the full technical strategy for migrating thepatna.org from its current WordPress-hosted site to a new, AI-ready digital platform with a central PostgreSQL database, a gated community layer, and a modern Next.js front-end. It is intended as a briefing document for the lead developer.

Migration at a glance



The migration uses a **parallel build strategy** — the new platform is developed and tested alongside the live WordPress site. Downtime at cutover is under 15 minutes. WordPress remains on standby for 2–4 weeks post-launch as a live fallback.

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Recommended Tech Stack

Framework	Next.js (App Router)	Public site + gated /app routes in one codebase · SSR for SEO
Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL)	Auth, RLS, vector store for AI layer — recommended choice
DB Alt.	Neon.tech	Lower cost · serverless Postgres · auth must be wired separately
CMS	Payload CMS	Lives in Next.js codebase · native Postgres · no external service
CMS Alt.	Sanity	Polished hosted editor · adds external dependency
Hosting	Vercel	Native Next.js · global CDN · zero-config deployments
AI Layer	Supabase pgvector	RAG integration for Phase 2 · vector column type built-in

Supabase vs Neon	Supabase is strongly preferred. Auth, Row Level Security, and the vector store for the AI layer (Phase 2) are all built in, removing significant integration work. Neon is cheaper but requires separate auth plumbing. Given the PRD's AI ambitions, Supabase pays for itself quickly.
Payload vs Sanity	Payload CMS lives entirely within the Next.js codebase and uses Postgres natively — ideal for keeping the entire stack in one place. Sanity is a hosted service with a polished editor but adds an external dependency and additional cost.
Content freeze window	During the parallel build period a brief window exists where content updates must be made in both WordPress (live) and the new CMS (staging). Handle this by freezing non-critical updates for a short sprint before cutover, or by scripting a nightly sync.

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Platform Architecture

www.thepatna.org

The new platform serves two distinct zones from a single Next.js application and one central database:

Public site	thepatna.org/*	No login	Home · About · Insights · Projects · Events · Community landing · Work With Us
Gated community	thepatna.org/app/*	Members only	Dashboard · Spaces · Member directory · Insights (full) · AI layer (Phase 2)
Admin	thepatna.org/admin/*	Admin role	Applications · Users · Cohorts · Content · Tags · Work With Us pipelines
Auth	thepatna.org/auth/*	Public	Login · Forgot password · Reset · Accept invite

The Community page is accessible via the main navigation as a public-facing landing page that explains PATNA's cohorts and the join process. Authenticated community functionality lives under /app — fully separate from the public site, gated by Supabase Auth + RLS.

Migration Phases

Parallel build strategy — no extended downtime

Phase 0 Preparation

Weeks 1–2 · No user impact

- Spin up Supabase project and configure PostgreSQL schema (data model already defined in project docs).
- Stand up Next.js codebase on a staging URL: **staging.thepatna.org**.
- Export all WordPress content — posts, pages, media — using WP's native XML exporter.
- Write import scripts to map WordPress content into the new Insights schema.
- The live WordPress site remains entirely untouched throughout this phase.

Phase 1 Build in parallel

Weeks 2–5 · WordPress stays live

- Build and QA the complete public site on staging: all pages, multilingual support (EN/FR/PT/AR), Insights hub, Community landing + EOI form.
- Migrate all WordPress posts and pages into the new Payload CMS.
- Run comprehensive QA: mobile, accessibility (WCAG 2.1), load speed (<3s), against a copy of production data.
- Build the gated /app routes: member dashboard, spaces, directory, insights library.
- Set up admin panel: applications pipeline, invite flow, user management.

Phase 2 Member pre-registration

Weeks 5–6 · Community seeding

- Before cutover, reach out to existing PATNA members and contacts with secure invite links.
- Members create accounts and complete onboarding on the staging environment.
- This seeds the community so members are not entering an empty platform on launch day.
- The invite system (already designed in the Jira Epics) handles this natively via Supabase Auth.

Phase 3 Cutover

Day X · Target <15 minutes downtime

- **Step 1:** Reduce DNS TTL to 60 seconds, 48 hours before cutover day.
- **Step 2:** Set WordPress to a custom maintenance page (not the default WP page).
- **Step 3:** Run a final content sync from WordPress to the new CMS.
- **Step 4:** Update DNS A/CNAME records to point thepatna.org to Vercel.
- **Step 5:** Disable maintenance mode on the new site. Platform is live.
- WordPress remains running for 2–4 weeks as a warm fallback. Rollback = single DNS change.

Phase 4 Decommission

Week 8+ · Cleanup

- Confirm no broken links, 404s, or missing media assets via crawl.
- Archive the full WordPress XML export for institutional records.
- Shut down WordPress hosting. thepatna.org is now entirely the new platform.
- Restore DNS TTL to normal value (e.g. 3600 seconds).

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Website Mockups

Homepage & Community page

Interactive HTML mockups have been produced for the Homepage and the Community page, incorporating PATNA's brand colour scheme (#03529d / #b9e8fa / #ffffff) and all content from the approved website copy document. The mockups are delivered as a single self-contained **patna_mockup.html** file with a page switcher at the top.

Homepage	Hero + stats · Origin story · Values · Projects grid · Insights preview · Partners · Join CTA · Footer	All nav links wired · Language toggle · Join CTA routes to Community page
Community page	Hero · 4 cohorts · How joining works (4-step process) · Spaces preview (locked) · EOI form · Footer	EOI form fields match Supabase applications table schema · Form submission to be wired in Phase 1

Fonts used in mockup: DM Serif Display (headings) + Plus Jakarta Sans (body). Both are available on Google Fonts and should be added to the Next.js project via next/font.

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Outstanding Decisions

Items requiring sign-off before build starts

Database provider	Supabase recommended	Confirm budget for Supabase Pro (~\$25/mo) vs Neon free tier + DIY auth
CMS	Payload CMS recommended	Confirm preference: Payload (in-codebase, Postgres-native) vs Sanity (hosted)
Content freeze window	Needs agreement	Agree on a content freeze date 1–2 weeks before cutover to stop WP updates
Multilingual approach	next-intl recommended	Confirm whether Phase 1 includes all 4 languages or EN first
Domain registrar	Needs confirmation	Confirm who holds DNS access for thepatna.org to plan cutover day

